

### 5.3.3 Bio-psychology

Bio-psychology is concerned with the role that physiology may play in psychological processes and behaviour. This sub-section looks at two aspects of physiological influence upon individuals: stress and the development of sex and gender awareness.

**Note** that a detailed knowledge of biological processes is not required.



#### **Stress**

Candidates should:

- be able to define stress e.g. Seyle's GAS model;
- demonstrate knowledge of the physiological (biological) and psychological (cognitive and behavioural) signs of stress;
- be able to describe physiological and psychological ways of measuring stress;
- demonstrate knowledge of research into possible causes of stress e.g. heat, noise, pollution, architecture, crowding, stressful life events.

#### **Sex and Gender**

Candidates should:

- be able to define sex typing, sex identity, gender identity and androgyny (Bem);
- demonstrate knowledge of biological factors in sex differences e.g. the role of hormones and genetics;
- be able to demonstrate knowledge of alternative explanations of sex/gender role development e.g. social learning theory, psychoanalytic (Freud), cognitive approach (Kohlberg);
- consider cultural differences in gender role development.